



MEETING RECORD

Priorities and Actions

NZALC COMMAND AND STAFF MEETING

New Zealand Army Leadership Centre | Army Command School

Reference: Meeting notes, September 2026 · Date: September 2026

KEY TAKEAWAY

The centre's problem is no longer primarily designing good training. The material and delivery architecture are increasingly mature. The next phase is about institutionalising it: instructor behaviours, induction, SOPs, assurance, administrative discipline, and ensuring programmes such as Nemesis genuinely deliver the outcomes they claim to deliver.

Five Priorities

1. **Course delivery is in a strong position.** Lead Teams and ELDA delivery is producing good outcomes and the updated packages, tools and workbooks are aligned. The key vulnerability is now instructor engagement and consistency, particularly ensuring instructors actually use the updated material as designed.
2. **Contractor onboarding needs immediate tightening.** The recent contractor experience exposed gaps in induction, safety briefing, role suitability and due diligence. The individual should not be re-engaged, but the larger lesson is to establish a clear, repeatable staff and contractor onboarding SOP rather than treating this as an isolated personnel issue.
3. **Nemesis needs a deliberate curriculum decision.** It currently appears closer to a challenging rite-of-passage experience than a genuine equivalent of Lead Teams. The missing elements are particularly the structured cognitive preparation, coaching and reflection, and recovery phases. This needs to be resolved with OCS and Army leadership: either clarify Nemesis's distinct purpose or redesign it to achieve the intended Lead Teams outcomes.
4. **Administration and assurance need continued focus.** H&S audit actions, visitor management, signage, security training, POs and invoices and contractor administration are progressing but require active tracking. Jim's field strengths are recognised; the answer is to provide more deliberate administrative support and prioritisation around him rather than allowing critical tasks to drift.
5. **The unit is otherwise in a good operational position.** Courses, November activities, leave, end-of-year events and leadership-development work are broadly on track. The recent push to close outstanding work appears to have materially improved the unit's position.

Consolidated Action List

Actions for Mike unless otherwise stated. High-priority actions are shaded.

Priority	Action	Owner	Timing
High	Chase remaining Lead Leaders officer nominations and confirm final attendance	Mike	Tomorrow
High	Follow up Lighthouse approval for Engineer Survival	Mike	ASAP
High	Review and tighten the staff and contractor onboarding and induction SOP, including safety induction, supervision, due diligence and documented completion	Mike	ASAP
High	Close out the contractor engagement and ensure no expectation of future work remains. Jim makes the formal close-out call; Mike is accountable for confirming closure	Jim (call); Mike (closure)	ASAP
High	Work with Army and OCS leadership to clarify Nemesis versus Lead Teams: intended outcomes, perform and recovery phases, coaching and appropriate positioning	Mike	Upcoming
High	Track outstanding H&S audit actions, including kayak audit follow-up	Mike	Ongoing
Medium	Coordinate with Jim and Dave Bertram on leadership journal use and briefing for current and upcoming courses	Mike	Current courses
Medium	Prepare the ATG submission presentation and have Dave review it	Mike	Wed to Thu
Medium	Develop the leadership-development programme for the 16 to 17 Nov Linton team-building activity, including allocation of instructors and session responsibilities	Mike	Before Nov
Medium	Organise the end-of-year farewell event, investigating the week of 23 Nov as the preferred option	Mike	Confirm soon
Medium	Provide Jim targeted admin support, particularly safety assurance, contractor administration and PO tracking	Mike	Ongoing

Ownership Note

The formal close-out call to the contractor belongs to Jim, who was tasked with it at the meeting. Mike remains accountable for ensuring the engagement is closed and that no expectation of future work remains, and for the wider fix: a repeatable onboarding SOP rather than a one-off personnel response.